

1815

BATTLE OF WATERLOO

In a gruelling battle near Waterloo (in Belgium) on 18 June 1815, Anglo-Allied and Prussian armies under the Duke of Wellington and General Blücher finally ended the Napoleonic Wars. Wellington's forces endured a fierce French assault before Blücher's Prussians arrived, freeing Wellington for a final offensive that drove the French from the field. Napoleon was caught and exiled to Saint Helena.

▷ Battle of Waterloo



1815

1816-58 The Seminole Wars

between the US and the Seminole Tribe in Florida are the bloodiest of the US-American Indian Wars

“Believe me, nothing except a battle lost can be half so melancholy as a battle won.”

ARTHUR WELLESLEY, THE DUKE OF WELLINGTON, ON THE BATTLE OF WATERLOO;
LETTER FROM THE FIELD OF WATERLOO, JUNE 1815


1769-1852
DUKE OF WELLINGTON

Arthur Wellesley, the Duke of Wellington, was a veteran of the Peninsular War and Napoleon's greatest rival. He was deeply affected by the horrors of Waterloo; it was his last battle.

1816

SHAKA BEGINS BUILDING THE ZULU EMPIRE

The son of Senzangakhona, King of the Zulus, Shaka transformed the kingdom through a series of military, social, and political reforms. He quadrupled the size of the Zulu army and introduced a system of promotion by merit rather than birth, creating a highly trained and disciplined force that would go on to conquer large areas of southern Africa and challenge the British army.

▷ Shaka, King of the Zulus

